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INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY DUE DILIGENCE REPORT

Project Tamarisk — Halverson HX-7 patent portfolio

Prepared for:	Northstar Cell Technologies plc
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With patent input from:	Hartington IP (Dr Charlotte Mensah, Patent Attorney)
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Status:	Confidential — Legally Privileged — Draft for client

1. Executive summary

We have reviewed the patent portfolio that Halverson Materials Limited (**Halverson**) proposes to license to Northstar Cell Technologies plc (**Northstar**) under Project Tamarisk. The portfolio comprises five members across three patent families: a core composition-of-matter family (granted in EP, US), a manufacturing-process patent (granted GB), and two improvement filings (one EP application pending examination; one PCT family in national phase). The granted rights are subsisting and renewal fees are paid to date. Our principal points of attention are set out at paragraph 5.

2. Scope and sources

We reviewed the patent register and prosecution histories provided by Hartington IP, the assignment chain from the named inventors to Halverson, the freedom-to-operate note dated 30 September 2025, and Halverson's responses to our IP due-diligence questionnaire. We have not conducted an independent validity or infringement search; our comments on validity are limited to matters apparent on the face of the granted patents.

3. Ownership and chain of title

The inventions were made by Dr Anders Halverson and Dr Wei Tan in the course of their employment. Deeds of assignment from each inventor to Halverson are in place and have been recorded against EP3 842 119 and US 11,654,302. We recommend that, as a condition of completion, Halverson record the assignment of GB 2 591 044 and confirm in the Disclosure Letter that no co-ownership or employee-compensation claims are outstanding.

4. Portfolio status

Patent / application	Jurisdiction	Status	Expiry
EP3 842 119 B1	EP (UK, DE, FR)	Granted	14/03/2039
US 11,654,302 B2	United States	Granted	02/11/2039
GB 2 591 044 B	United Kingdom	Granted	27/01/2040
EP4 015 887 A1	EP	Pending examination	03/12/2041*
PCT/GB2022/051883	UK/US/EP/JP/KR	National phase	21/07/2042*

* Expiry of pending applications is the anticipated 20-year term from filing, contingent on grant.

5. Key issues and recommendations

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5.1 Pending EP application (EP4 015 887). The cathode-electrolyte interphase additive — central to the performance claims Northstar is relying on — is the subject of a pending EP application, not a granted patent. Northstar should treat the additive package primarily as licensed know-how, and the Licence should confirm that the know-how licence survives even if the application does not proceed to grant.

5.2 Territory carve-out (China). Halverson has separately licensed the composition family in the People's Republic of China to a third party. The Project Tamarisk licence must therefore exclude China from the Territory. We have reflected this in the draft Licence (definition of "Territory").

5.3 Renewal management. Total annual renewal cost across the portfolio is approximately £16,700. The Licence places prosecution and maintenance on Halverson at its own cost (clause 7.1); Northstar should retain a step-in right to pay renewals if Halverson defaults, which we have requested.

5.4 Freedom to operate. The Hartington IP FTO note identifies two third-party sulphide-electrolyte patents of potential relevance. Neither is considered by Hartington to be infringed by the HX-7 composition, but Northstar should obtain the warranty at clause 8.1(d) and the indemnity position should be reviewed against its product roadmap.

6. Conclusion

Subject to the points in paragraph 5 being addressed in the Licence and Disclosure Letter, the portfolio is fit to support the proposed exclusive field-limited licence. We are content for Northstar to proceed on the basis of the draft Licence circulated on 24 October 2025.

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